

Speed Dating

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Character profile for person going on speed dates:

- **Asmee** (late 20s/early 30s and Sri Lankan/ Nepali) is a finance bro through and through. She loves Excel, always on the go, and enjoys the fancier side of life. Coming from a low-income upbringing, she's a self-made woman- unapologetic and tired of men's bullshit - Wharton grad summa cum laude, and senior associate at her firm. She lives to die on Wall Street. Due to her job, she's mostly always dressed in business formal. While she aspires to be *the* intimidating boss-lady woman, she is petite, at 5'0"- best. She just has the build and facial features that, try as she might, make her seem "cute". Her biggest turn-off is when a potential partner acts super macho in a disrespectful way. Unfortunately, finance bros, who she's surrounded by all day, tend to act super macho in a disrespectful way. Recently out of a 8-year long relationship with her college boyfriend who was super non-committal, and due to pressure from her parents about getting married, Asmee's enlisted Seema Aunty's services. Asmee's not super connected to her culture, but she grew up in a household with her immigrant parents and grandparents running a restaurant in Atlanta, GA. She's had a difficult time with accepting her Desiness because she wasn't invited into Indian friend groups in high school - her being Sri Lankan/ Nepali - and also has trauma from Desi aunties making fun of her body/nerdiness/etc. Since her parents were really persistent about finding a Desi partner, she's decided to give Seema Aunty a try.
- Context: Presumably, Seema Aunty has looked for matches for Asmee, but because of Asmee's busy schedule, taste mismatches, fights with Seema Aunty because of her "60%-70%" rule, or whatever else reason, nothing so far has worked out. Asmee is not really Seema Aunty's priority because their personalities don't get along, but Asmee is low-key rich, so maybe that keeps Seema Aunty motivated to help?

Characters:

SEEMA

ASMEE

HASAN (perfect <3)

GUY 1 (astrology)

POOKIE

ACT 1

Interview style: SEEMA AUNTY from now on. She's discussing another client of hers.

SEEMA AUNTY

(shaking head)

You know, usually I have no trouble at all finding matches from my database. I mean I'm very good at my job. But this one girl, Asmee, she's very difficult.

SEEMA and ASMEE are meeting in an apt. ASMEE goes in for a handshake; Seema does some prayer hands. Awkward pause, and they shake hands. ASMEE seems very sweet.

Interview style on ASMEE.

ASMEE

(cute)

–Seema Aunty? Yeah! She's nice. I think she's just very out of touch with reality...

CUT TO:

- *Action line*

ASMEE

(re: interview style)

Hi! I'm Asmee, 32. I am an Atlanta native and grew up in a large family, parents, grandparents, aunties, and uncles... I work in finance, and I love my job, but it does get lonely. And at this point in my life, I've realized that family is very important to me, and I really want to create a family of my own someday - I don't want something too serious too fast, though!

CUT TO:

SEEMA AUNTY

(shaking head)

Kids these days. I mean, she's 32! She's too too old to have babies.

CUT TO:

ASMEE

It definitely takes a while for me to really get to know someone and let my guard down.

CUT TO:

SEEMA AUNTY

Lots of hand gestures (claps hands at boom)

Ideally, I'm going for a 3 month timeline with her. Meet. Parents talk. Wedding. Boom.

CUT TO:

ASMEE

But, I'm ready to really take finding a relationship seriously. A friend of mine told me about Seema Aunty and, well, here we are!

INT: ASMEE's apartment. Seema is showing ASMEE some biodatas. ASMEE's wearing business formal clothes or a turtleneck, more professional or masculine or something of the sort. Aunty-disapproving.

SEEMA AUNTY

So, what I have done for you is pulled some biodatas and we are going to set up a speed date type thing for you. This works very well, trust me. Make sure to wear something... pretty, ok?

ASMEE

Haha... okay.

EXT: ASMEE, wearing a power suit (brown?), is about to enter the cafe, and Seema's giving her a "pep talk".

ASMEE/ SEEMA:

Hi Seema Aunty! / Beta, this is not an interview.

ASMEE, a little confused, but shakes it off.

SEEMA

(outloud)

Maybe boys nowadays don't care about appearance.

A beat.

SEEMA

Ok hurry in! They're waiting.

SEEMA pushes a confused ASMEE into the cafe.

INT: Cute cafe downtown. Vibey music. ASMEE brushes herself off and puts on a smile. She wants this to go well. HASAN, 27, is waiting near the door. He's more hippie-ish? Notices ASMEE by the door. Waves at her. HASAN has two coffees waiting. Iced mocha with oat milk, 2 pumps of lavender, whipped cream on top (for him). Black coffee (for her). He's very good-looking, but ASMEE has her doubts - he looks young. A camera is following this interaction, and that's us!

HASAN

(in love!)

Wow, you look even better than your biodata, haha.

ASMEE

Yeah... haha, thanks. I forgot to send Seema my photo, so she pulled it from my Facebook from college.

HASAN

Y'know, she did the *same thing* to me. I had to beg her to update my profile.

They both laugh. ASMEE is very comfortable around him.

HASAN

I ordered you a drink.

ASMEE

Oh, I don't like suga–

HASAN

–You seemed like a black coffee kind of girl

ASMEE

Black coffee is perfect. Thank you.

They laugh again. More comfortable.

HASAN

Black coffee is impressive. I could never. I find that a sugar high beats a caffeine high for the 5am grind.

ASMEE

5 am?!?!

HASAN

Yeah, I do Soul Cycle at 6am, and I'm a trader.

ASMEE

Oh my god! I also wake up at 5am! I'm in Private Equity.

HASAN

I love a smart woman.

They laugh again. More comfortable. She blushes.

HASAN

So-

His hand was on the table or holding a cup of coffee, and as he goes in to flirt, spills coffee on himself. Spills it on his shirt. Wearing a white shirt.

ASMEE

Oh! Are you okay?

HASAN

No worries, it was an iced mocha!

*HASAN rolls up his sleeves. Peak at biceps. ASMEE looks at the camera (The Office style) as he is focused on his shirt and gapes her mouth at [how ripped] he is.
As ASMEE is grabbing a napkin to help dab away at HASAN'S coffee spill, SEEMA interrupts with a bang. SEEMA rushes in pulling Guy 1 along with her. She guides HASAN out of his seat.*

SEEMA

(re: Hasan)

Let's go, beta. Time's up!

(re: guy 1)

Your turn.

Seema rushes away. Hasan looks back and ASMEE and HASAN smile at each other. Hasan signals to ASMEE, "call me!". ASMEE realizes they don't have each other's contacts yet.

POOKIE

(doing the pookie dance)

AY, POOKIE! HEY, POOKIE!

As ASMEE is confused.

POOKIE

(silently doing the pookie dance)

Pookie??

ASMEE looks at camera bewildered.

ASMEE

Actually... it's Asmee...?

ASMEE is confused x100. Caught off-guard. But not judgemental, maybe a lil freaked.

ASMEE

... what are you doing?

POOKIE

(does dance again, pulls out sunglasses - watch video for reference)

Am I your roman empire? Am I your roman empire? How many times did you think about me?
How many times did you think about me? How many times did you think about me Pookayyy?

ASMEE

Dude, actually, what? Are you okay?

POOKIE

If it was up to me, I would've chosen to be nonchalant and sexy, but God wanted me to be loud and sassy. Guilty! Guilty! Guilty! You don't choose to be sassy! What can I say? What can I

say? What can I say, Pookie?

Pookie hands

ASMEE

—maybe your name?

POOKIE

Oh, you want to say my name? Really, Pookie? (does pookie dance again)
...no one's ever asked me that before. Usually, people just want to know Pookie...

ASMEE

OK, so your name?

POOKIE

POOKIE kinda snaps out of the pookie bit.

Prayag. My name is Prayag.

ASMEE

(warm smile)

Well, nice to meet you, Prayag. What do you do?

POOKIE

I am a little bit famous online. I actually went to school for business but made some Tiktoks that went viral and people started labeling me as “sassy”. I didn't know how to feel about it, but I've come to embrace it, and it's honestly really empowering. I feel like what I do helps challenge toxic masculinity.

ASMEE

Oh wow. That's honestly amazing. It sounds like you're impacting a lot of people.

POOKIE

You like what I do? You like what I do Pookie????

SEEMA butts in with the third and final guy. Rushes POOKIE out. POOKIE is doing Pookie hands on the way out- maybe is calling SEEMA pookie. ASMEE looks at the camera with a sigh of relief. Guy #2 is reallyyy hot, very normal looking (nice collared shirt, khakis etc).

ASMEE

Hey! [x], right? Hi, I am Asmee -

GUY #2

[last name]. Seema gave me your biodata.

ASMEE

Oh. Cool, same –

GUY #2

– we need to face the West, and the lighting here does not bode well for marriage. So, let's go there.

ASMEE

Oh.. yeah that's fine I guess.

Looks at the camera, confused, as they move to another table.

GUY #2

Yeah, I charted your stars to see how compatible we are and looks like we have an 85.7 percent match. Better than most of the dates Seema's set me up on!

ASMEE

My stars? Uhm. Well, how many of these have you been on?

GUY #2

Well, let's see, there was that one Cancer, Two Libras, 4 capricorns, a Scorpio, and you're my first Taurus, so.. 9 now.

ASMEE

Wow, so you're really into all this astrology stuff, yeah?

GUY #2

Yeah.. but I don't really like the term "astrology". It's a science.

ASMEE

Huh. I mean I have Costar....?

GUY #2

Oh, trust me, that stuff is all wrong. You gotta see my stars guy.

ASMEE

Right... Well, so how did you meet Seema Aunty?

GUY #2

We have the same stars guy. I have to get married before the Pluto retrograde is over, or my horoscope indicates that I'll become deathly allergic to Pav Bhaji. Or at least, that's what my stars guy said.

A beat.

GUY #2

Did you know that we have similar charts? Your chart says that you can't have kids if you don't get married by the end of this year. And you should really wear more rubies... more feminine, you know?

**pulls out chart* drones on, not looking up at ASMEE.*

So when the Nakshatra is Punarvasu and 45 degrees to the West, you'll start feeling hungry. It's actually like that today! Is that why you're eating this pastry?

ASMEE gets up to leave.

Oh! Mars is in your 7th house so you probably find it tough to—

—ASMEE runs from the cafe, SEEMA is talking to someone on her phone. SEEMA notices.

SEEMA

Arey? Why are you leaving? You have 45 seconds left with him!

ASMEE

I actually have an engagement party I have to go to!

SEEMA

Baap re baap, you care more about other people getting married than your own marriage.

ASMEE

Bye, Seema Aunty.

SEEMA looks back at her phone and waves.

ACT 2

ASMEE enters the engagement party in a nicer outfit finding her assigned table. She sits down and is coincidentally seated next to HASAN.

HASAN

Asmee! Nice to see you here! Do you know Alina??

ASMEE

I'm actually a friend of Salma's.

HASAN

Me too.....?

ASMEE

Wow, small world huh??

HASAN

Yes! We've actually been friends since grade school.

ASMEE

They were my college roommate!

HASAN

You're THE ASMEE?!?

ASMEE

Oh god, hopefully you've only heard good things.

HASAN

Crazy things, but yes, good things. Wow, it was almost like we were meant to meet.

ASMEE blushes.

ANNOUNCER

Booming voice over speakers

Please silence your cellphones, the show is about to begin.

HASAN

Before we put our phones away, can I have your number?

ASMEE

I was just about to ask.

Warmly smiles.

_____ *fashion show starts* _____

[Seniors]

